

NARRATIVE WRITING

Structure and Organisation

A well-structured narrative has an organised beginning, middle and end that helps the reader follow your story.

THE NARRATIVE STRUCTURE

1

BEGINNING

Set the scene and introduce the key elements.

- Introduce the setting
- Introduce the main character(s)
- Hint at the problem or goal

Hook your reader and make them want to keep reading!



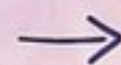
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MIDDLE

Develop the story with a series of events.

- Build tension or interest
- Include challenges or conflicts
- Show how the characters respond
- Use time order to keep events clear

Keep events in a logical order so readers can follow easily.



3

ENDING

Bring the story to a satisfying close.

- Resolve the problem or conflict
- Show the outcome
- Leave the reader with a feeling or thought

A good ending ties things together and stays with your reader.



STAY ORGANISED!

Strong organisation helps your story flow.

Check your writing:



Clear Setting

Is the time and place easy to understand?



Consistent Characters

Are your characters' actions and feelings believable?



Logical Sequence

Do events happen in a sensible order?



Clear Problem and Resolution

Is the problem solved or resolved?



Strong Closing

Does the ending feel complete and meaningful?

TIPS FOR GREAT ORGANISATION



PLAN FIRST

Use a planning graphic organiser to map your beginning, middle and end.



USE TRANSITIONS

Words like *then*, *next*, *suddenly*, *after that*, *finally* help your story flow.



CHECK YOUR WORK

Reread to make sure your events make sense and your writing is clear.



SHOW, DON'T TELL

Use actions, dialogue and details to bring your story to life.

Well-structured stories are easier to read, more exciting to follow and more powerful for your reader!



NARRATIVE WRITING

Language Features

Great narratives use powerful language to create vivid pictures, engage the reader and bring the story to life.

1. VIVID DESCRIPTIVE LANGUAGE

Use adjectives, adverbs and adverbs and figurative language to paint a picture in the reader's mind.

EXAMPLE:

"The sun dipped below the **jagged** mountains, casting a **golden glow** across the still lake."

2. FIGURATIVE LANGUAGE

Similes, metaphors and personification add depth and make writing more interesting.

EXAMPLE:

"The wind howled **like a hungry wolf**, whipping through the dark trees."

3. STRONG VERBS

Powerful verbs show action and help the reader feel like they are part of the story.

EXAMPLE:

"Lily **sprinted** across the field, **dodged** the tackle and **kicked** the ball toward the goal."

4. DIALOGUE

Dialogue brings characters to life, shows their personality and moves the story forward.

EXAMPLE:

"Are you sure this is the right way?" asked Tom.
"I think so," replied Mia, trying to sound confident."

5. SHOW, DON'T TELL

Show the reader what happens through actions, thoughts and feelings rather than telling them.

EXAMPLE:

Telling: He was nervous.

Showing: His palms sweated, his heart pounded, and he kept glancing at the clock.

6. SENSORY DETAILS

Use the five senses (sight, sound, smell, touch, taste) to create a rich and immersive experience.

EXAMPLE:

"The **crackling** fire popped, filling the cabin with the **warm** smell of **woodsmoke** and toasted bread."

7. EMOTIVE LANGUAGE

Words that express emotion help the reader connect with the characters and care about what happens.

EXAMPLE:

"Sophie felt a surge of **relief** wash over her, like a heavy weight finally lifted."

8. VARIETY OF SENTENCE STRUCTURE

Mix short, punchy sentences with longer, more detailed ones to create pace, tension and emphasis.

EXAMPLE:

"The door creaked open. A chill swept through the room. Something moved in the shadows."

WHY THESE FEATURES MATTER



They engage the reader.



They create vivid images and emotion.



They build tension and keep readers turning the page.



They turn a good story into an unforgettable one!

WRITER'S TIP

Don't just include these features—use them purposefully. The best writers choose the right language at the right time to make their story shine.



NARRATIVE WRITING

Annotated Exemplar

See how this narrative uses structure, language features and techniques to tell an engaging story.

THE NIGHT I FOUND COURAGE

VIVID DESCRIPTION

Figurative language ("like a pack of wolves") creates a strong image and sets a tense mood.

FOCUS ON THE MOMENT

The writer zooms in on feelings and senses to pull the reader into the experience.

SENSES

Sight, sound and touch help the reader imagine being there.

BUILDING TENSION

Short sentences and strong verbs create suspense and keep the reader turning the page.

ORIENTATION

The setting and situation are introduced so the reader understands where and when the story takes place.

COMPLICATION

The challenge is revealed: the hidden waterfall and the fear of the unknown.

CLIMAX

The turning point—the moment the character reaches the waterfall. This is the most exciting part!

RESOLUTION

The problem is overcome and the character reflects on what they have learned.

SATISFYING ENDING

A gentle, reflective closing leaves the reader with a warm, lasting feeling.

The wind howled through the trees like a pack of wolves, and the darkness closed in around the tiny cabin.

I clutched the map in my sweaty hands, my heart thudding in my chest. This was it. I had to do it.

Finding the hidden waterfall had been Mum's dream. Now it was up to me.

I took a deep breath and stepped onto the creaky path. Branches scratched my arms. Shadows danced between the trees. Every snap and whisper made me jump, but I kept going.

After what felt like hours, I heard it—the rush of water! Pushing through the last of the bushes, I gasped. There it was—a silver ribbon cascading down the rocks, sparkling in the moonlight. It was even more beautiful than I had imagined.

In that moment, I felt something change inside me. I had been scared, but I didn't let fear stop me. I did something brave. I found the waterfall. I found courage.

As I turned to head back, the wind seemed softer, as if the forest was smiling.

LANGUAGE FEATURES HIGHLIGHTED

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------------|
| Simile | Short, punchy sentences |
| Emotive language | Dialogue |
| Sensory details | Reflection |
| Strong verbs | Personification |

KEY TAKEAWAYS



PLAN YOUR STORY

A clear structure (beginning, middle, end) keeps your story focused.



USE VIVID LANGUAGE

Descriptive words and figurative language help readers see what you see.



SHOW, DON'T TELL

Use actions, dialogue and sensory details to show how characters feel.



BUILD TENSION

Create challenges and use pacing to keep your reader engaged.



END WITH IMPACT

A strong resolution and reflection leave your reader thinking long after the story is finished.

Great stories combine an exciting journey with powerful language to create an unforgettable experience.